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## Gone Batty



*ISSN 1544-1423*

by Brian Weilert

**Dr. Long:** Very well, let's go ahead and get started. Why don't you relax, sit down and tell me why you are here.

**Bruce:** Dr. Long, I just don't feel adequate anymore. I don't think I'm as important as in the past.

**Dr. Long:** When did this start Mr. Wayne?

**Bruce:** It started when I realized that in comparison to others in my field, I fell way short of the mark.

**Dr. Long:** And just what *field* are we talking about?

**Bruce:** Crime fighting

**Dr. Long:** Oh, are you a police officer Bruce? Is it ok if I call you Bruce?

**Bruce:** That's fine. No, I'm not a cop.

**Dr. Long:** An attorney? A judge? What?

**Bruce:** A super hero.

**Dr. Long:** *(laughing)* Bruce, if we are ever to make any progress then we must stay on task.

**Bruce:** Dr. Long, I'm telling the truth. I discovered a cave with bats. Perhaps you've heard of me? I'm...

**Dr. Long:** *(interrupting)* BRUCE!

**Bruce:** Yes, doc?

**Dr. Long:** We only have a 50 minute hour so really, let's try to stay focused. When did it all start?

**Bruce:** My first feelings of inadequacy began two years ago when I had a hardened criminal cornered at the end of an alley. He kept laughing at me and joking. I became enraged and attacked. Right when I nearly had him in my hands, he flew into the air and disappeared. It seems he was wearing some sort of jet pack under his purple suit.

**Dr. Long:** *(doubtful)* Ok, then what happened?

**Bruce:** Nothing. That was it. I couldn't do anything about it.

**Dr. Long:** But Bruce I thought you were a super hero? Why didn't you just take flight and go after him? Why Bruce?

**Bruce:** Because I can't. I am Ba...

**Dr. Long:** *(interrupting)* BRUCE! You couldn't because you are **not** a super hero. Stand up Bruce and I will show you. Great. Now fly over my head, land behind me and put me in a choke hold. Go.

**Bruce:** I can't.

**Dr. Long:** Exactly. Now, sit back down.

**Bruce:** But... I...

**Dr. Long:** Quiet! Can we try a little reality for a moment. What is your relationship like with your mother?

**Bruce:** Doc, that has nothing to do with this. My mother is dead.

**Dr. Long:** *(Taking notes, to self)* Infatuated with dead mother....

**Bruce:** I didn't say that!

**Dr. Long:** *(Taking notes, to self)* In a depressed state of denial.....

**Bruce:** *(standing)* I didn't say that either!

**Dr. Long:** *(Taking notes, to self)* Repeats self, could be schizophrenic....

**Bruce:** Hey stop it! I'm WARNING YOU!

**Dr. Long:** *(looking up)* What are you going to do Bruce? Melt me with your laser eyes?

**Bruce:** *(discouraged)* I can't.

**Dr Long:** Twist me into a pretzel with you awesome strength?

**Bruce:** *(even more dejected)* Can't.

**Dr. Long:** Cloud my mind with evil thoughts.

**Bruce:** *(almost silent)* Can't

**Dr. Long:** Sit down Bruce.

**Bruce:** *(sitting)* Sorry.

**Dr. Long:** Now, Bruce what else has occurred that has brought you to this point of such self doubt?

**Bruce:** Well, another incident that really sticks out in my mind is when I had a great opportunity to make a good impression with a certain female feline .

**Dr. Long:** *(Taking notes, to self)* Confused sexual identity...

**Bruce:** *(Starts to protest)* I.... *(But then just continues)* Anyway, I was supposed to meet her downtown at midnight. I show up in my mobile. And I must mention my mobile is awesome.

**Dr. Long:** You mean car? Right?

**Bruce:** What else? Anyway, I see her waiting for me and so like a gentleman I hop out to open her door. But, as I do my utility belt gets hooked on the steering wheel and comes off my waist. It all happened so fast it's a blur. The next thing I know the door shuts with my belt on the navigation chair and the anti-intruder, laser activated, shutdown program initiated.

**Dr. Long:** *(Taking notes, to self)* Key chain on front seat with doors locked. *(To Bruce)* What next?

**Bruce:** Well, without my belt I couldn't do anything. That's the point! A super hero and I couldn't get into the mobile!

**Dr. Long:** Car, Bruce, Car. Let's not be too hard on yourself. We've all done that at one point or another.

**Bruce:** You don't understand, there's more to it.

**Dr. Long:** Go on.

**Bruce:** Well, she became angry at me for ruining the evening. She kept mentioning that she had turned down a better offer to see me.

**Dr. Long:** *(taking notes again)* A better offer?

**Bruce:** Yeah, she kept saying if this didn't work out he could be her in a FLASH.

**Dr. Long:** Go on.

**Bruce:** Well, she attacked. She came at me quick as a cat clawing and biting. As she face- slammed me into the drivers side window, I could see my utility belt taunting me just out of reach behind the bullet proof glass.

**Dr. Long:** What then?

**Bruce:** I don't know. I blacked out.

**Dr. Long:** Bruce, now does it sound feasible that a super hero could be beaten up by a girl?

**Bruce:** You don't get it! She was no ordinary woman. She was Ca.....

**Dr. Long:** *(interrupting) BRUCE!* The sooner you face the truth the better you are going to feel!

**Bruce:** (to himself) If I had my belt I would have kicked her....

**Dr. Long:** *(interrupting)* Class! Bruce. Have a little class.

**Bruce:** Sorry, doc. You're right of course.

**Dr. Long:** I want to talk a little bit about this *belt* you seem so attached to. What exactly does this *belt* do for you?

**Bruce:** Everything!

**Dr. Long:** Can it turn you into a bird?

**Bruce:** No, that would be silly.

**Dr. Long:** Can it make you swim faster than a dolphin?

**Bruce:** No!

**Dr. Long:** Can it at least open a can of pork-n-beans Bruce?

**Bruce:** *(thinking to himself)* I suppose if I re-calibrated the high intensity laser, sure.

**Dr. Long:** Bruce, maybe you need to redefine e*verything*.

**Bruce:** *(very excited)* Wow, ok. You're not going to believe the power it holds. My favorite and most used tool is my Bat-a-rang. I always seem to need to pull it out and fling it at villains. I'll tell you it has gotten me out of quite a few jams. Then there is...

**Dr. Long:** *(interrupting)* Bruce, do you live alone?

**Bruce:** What? Why? What does that have to do with anything?

**Dr. Long:** Just answer the question.

**Bruce:** No, I live with my butler and another young man.

**Dr. Long:** And is this young man important to you?

**Bruce:** Yes, of course. He's a super hero too.

**Dr. Long:** I see, *(taking notes)* and does he find it necessary to whip his Bat-a-rang at villains as well?

**Bruce:** *(suspicious)* Well, yes of course.

**Dr. Long:** So, let me get this clear, just for my notes. You and this young man live together, and you both are super heros, and you both use your Bat-a-rangs extensively...

**Bruce:** *(finally catching on to what is being implied)* Hey now wait just a minute!!!!!

**Dr. Long:** Don't get your tights twisted in a knot. I'm just trying to explore the deep core that is layered by years of hurt and rejection. I'm trying to expose the inner Bruce, the real Bruce. To do so you must allow me to dig.

**Bruce:** *(Standing)* Your implication was a *dig* alright!

**Dr. Long:** You need to sit and calm down. Besides Bruce, really, what are you going to do about it? Nothing.

**Bruce:** I'll show you nothing! *(At this point he attacks Dr. Long. His first swing stops about 6 inches from the Doctor's face as he screams the word,)* **POW!** *(The next punch is an upper cut to the gut. Again about 6 inches from the target screaming the word,)* **BLAM!** *(Finally, he ends with a roundhouse kick no where near the Doctor with the word,)* **KABOOM!**

*The entire time the Doctor stands still with both hands at his/her side while shaking his/her head in disappointment. Bruce is breathing heavy as he stops and stares in disbelief at the lack of damage done to the doctor.*

**Dr. Long:** Ok Bruce if the devastating onslaught has come to an end, would you please sit back down so we can try to accomplish something today?

**Bruce:** I....I....don't understand.

**Dr. Long:** Exactly.

**Bruce:** NO! That has routine has stopped the most heinous criminals this world has ever seen.

**Dr. Long:** Bruce, STOP IT! You are not a super hero. You are an average Joe that is in severe depression. Say it Bruce, "I am not a super hero."

**Bruce:** Could it be true? Could all of this be in my head?

**Dr. Long:** Say it.

**Bruce:** I....am.....not....a....super...hero.

**Dr. Long:** Again.

**Bruce:** I am not a superhero.

**Dr. Long:** How does that feel?

**Bruce:** Wow, I feel better. If I'm not a superhero then I am not inadequate. I don't have feel weak for not being able to do all the things that I can't do. I can just be Bruce, not Ba....

**Dr. Long:** *(Interrupting)* You understand!
We have had a great breakthrough. I would like to follow up with a few more visits but I think we have made great strides today.

**Bruce:** I can't thank you enough Doc. I feel like a free man.

**Dr. Long:** Just be sure and see my secretary on the way out and she will set you up for our next appointment.

**Bruce:** *(Bruce rises, shakes the Doctor's hand and exits whispering under his breath,)* I am not a superhero. I am not a superhero.....

**Dr. Long:** *(After a beat or two the Doctor pantomimes pulling out a communication device. The doctor's voice has clearly changed to one of a villain.)* Master, I have completed the mission. I have managed to neutralized possibly the most powerful crime fighter in history. We can now take over the world. *(End with a sinister laugh)*

Tibetan Treefrog Publishing
111 N Eddy
Fort Scott, KS 66701
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